NTSB Part 830

Edition Oct 2026

Is it an accident? (830.2)

An occurrence between the time anyone boards *with the intention of flight* and the time everyone has gotten off, in which anyone suffers **death or serious injury**, or the aircraft receives **substantial damage**. A fatal injury is one that causes death within **30 days**.

Serious injury

- Hospital for more than 48 h, starting within 7 days of the injury
- Any broken bone, except simple fractures of fingers, toes or nose
- Severe bleeding, or nerve, muscle or tendon damage
- Any internal organ involved
- Second- or third-degree burns, or burns over more than 5% of the body

Substantial damage

Damage or failure that harms structural strength, performance or flight characteristics and would normally need major repair or replacement of the part.

Not substantial: small punctured holes in the skin or fabric, among other listed minor damage.

Notify the NTSB immediately (830.5)

After any accident, and after any of these listed incidents even if no one is hurt:

- Flight control system malfunction or failure
- A required flight crewmember unable to perform normal duties because of injury or illness
- In-flight fire
- Aircraft collision in flight
- Damage to property other than the aircraft estimated over **$25,000** (repair, or fair market value if a total loss, whichever is less)
- An overdue aircraft believed to have been in an accident

The rest of the 830.5 list covers turbine engines, propellers, rotors, large multiengine aircraft, cockpit displays, collision-avoidance alerts and air carriers.

NTSB Response Operations Center: **844-373-9922** or 202-314-6290

What to tell them (830.6)

Aircraft type, nationality and registration · owner and operator · pilot in command · date and time · last departure point and intended landing · position from an easily defined point · number aboard, killed and seriously injured · nature of the accident, weather and damage, so far as known · any explosives, radioactive or other dangerous articles aboard.

After the call

Wreckage (830.10)	Don't move it until the NTSB takes custody, except to free injured or trapped people, protect it from further damage, or protect the public. If you must move it, sketch, note and photograph where it lay. Keep all records.
Written report (830.15)	NTSB Form 6120.1/2 within **10 days** of an accident, or after **7 days** if an overdue aircraft is still missing. For a listed incident, only if the NTSB asks. Each crewmember able to do so attaches a statement.

Sources: 49 CFR 830.2, 49 CFR 830.5, 49 CFR 830.6, 49 CFR 830.10, 49 CFR 830.15. Original card, not an FAA document. brianfliesballoons.github.io/balloon-prep

Study aid, not for navigation.